Selling Your Services

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To

JOHN CALDWELL

the solution of whose problem inspired
this book

The Purpose of the Book

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AN axiom of life is that a man will be most successful in that field of work which he loves best. Granted that a man is naturally suited to some kind of work, then he will be able to absorb himself in that kind of work in such a way that it will become his hobby. He would rather do that than anything else in the world. He gives the work his heart interest and practically all his waking hours. The result is that he quite naturally succeeds in it. The work may not be of the kind that insures large financial gains; but he is happy in that kind of work. And, after all, this is what counts most.

The average man appreciates all this, but he is rather at sea as to how to attack the problem of getting into the work for which he is most naturally fitted.

The problem is one that can be governed by straight selling principles. The man has a product to market—his services. How shall he find the market for these? How develop a group of prospects for these services? How close the most desirable prospect into a customer, the employer for whom he can do the best work and who consequently can afford to pay him the maximum salary?

It is strange that one of the world's oldest commodities, labor, has had developed around it so little literature dealing with the actual processes of selling it. During recent years considerable study has been devoted to scientific methods of employing labor, but the marketing of a man's services—the individual's most vital consideration—remains practically untouched so far as literature covering a logical and systematic procedure is concerned.

This book has been written with a view to offering some suggestions for selling a man's services. There is no hocus-pocus to the methods suggested nor is it guaranteed that by memorizing the contents a man can at once secure a $25,000 job. It is believed, however, that, by

following the suggestions given, the average man will improve his chances of getting a hearing and, finally, of securing the job for which he is best suited.

The book has been written from practical experience. The authors followed the methods outlined in securing their own jobs. And since they have been placed in positions that put on them the responsibility of hiring men, they have had an opportunity to observe how badly the average applicant handles his case in selling his services. The average letter of application is weak; very often an employer feels after filling a position that, after all, perhaps, the best man for the job was overlooked because his letter of application was his weakest asset. Frequently the applicant manages his case poorly during the interview.

Suggestions are given for strengthening the entire "approach," as it is called in selling, and for "closing the sale" if the position seems to promise a business connection mutually satisfactory to employer and employee.

Keep Working

Keep Working

IF you are out of work, get some kind of job quickly. And do not quit one job before you have secured another. You may be able to give excellent reasons why you are out of work, or why your last employer was quite wrong, but nevertheless you will find your prospective employer naturally suspicious of the fellow who is not working. This suspicion is a distinctly American characteristic.

Get some kind of job. Then if you are satisfied that you are not doing the kind of work that does justice to your future, look for another.

But keep working!

Know Thyself

Know Thyself

TO begin from the point of view that getting the right position can be reduced to a merchandizing problem, the first step you must take is to inventory your qualifications in a definite manner. You need this inventory in making the correct choice of a position and in placing a value on your services for the position that seems most suitable.

In his book on "Vocational Psychology" Professor Hollingsworth states:

> In the absence of more reliable ways of determining the capacities, interests and vocational aptitudes of individuals in the past, and whenever there was any question of selection, fitness, or choice, four vague methods have often been followed:
>
> (1) The individual undertook the first available type of employment, tried it out, and then persevered in it or abandoned it for a trial at some other type of work until a suitable occupation was found.
>
> (2) He continued at the original work and made

the most of the results and of the ensuing satisfactions or dissatisfactions.

(3) He felt more or less clearly drawn to some particular occupation because of a keen interest in it or because he believed himself to be particularly likely to succeed in it because of his aptitudes and characteristics.

(4) He consulted friends and associates, asking them to advise him on the basis of their impression of his individuality and powers.

Professor Hollingsworth points out further that the unsatisfactoriness, waste, and misery of the first two of these methods are largely responsible for the development of an attempt to direct men into the classes of work for which they are best suited. If more use were made of the two remaining methods by the individual himself, less need would have arisen for the work of scientific employment departments and vocational guidance.

Professor Hollingsworth's conclusion, based on extensive research and study, is that not enough critical attention has been given to the methods of self-analysis and to the validity of the judgments passed on us by our associates.

Therefore, preface your campaign with a

critical analysis of yourself and your qualifications. And do not be satisfied with your own opinion as to your suitability for a particular position until you have gained the advantage of the judgments of your friends and business associates.

Know Thyself!

Your Best Prospect—Your Present Employer

Your Best Prospect—Your Present Employer

IN casting about with the idea of capitalizing your services to better advantage, consider the possibilities of your own employer. If you feel that your qualifications should make you more valuable to the company in some other capacity, do not be timid about discussing this with your superior. Broad-minded executives are interested in placing the right man in the right place. They want to avoid keeping square pegs in round holes.

If you have made a study of some particular kind of work that fits you for a definite position in the organization, go to your superior and discuss with him the possibilities of your capitalizing your special studies or training to the advantage of the company and yourself.

The best change you can make is a change to a different or better position in your own organization. Such a change enables you to capitalize the experience you have gained in becoming familiar with the products, organization, and policies of the company. Further, you build up an asset of proved loyalty to your company.

If you are not getting along as rapidly as you should with your present company, first look for the reasons within yourself. If after analyzing thoroughly your qualifications, you are satisfied that you could do bigger work, then the fault must be with your own salesmanship in putting forth these qualifications. Perhaps you are weak in the impression you make on your superiors or even your associates.

Getting along with your associates in business in a congenial, coöperative fashion is most important. It is almost a platitude to say that no man ever made any progress without the help of his fellows. This is borne out in history and in industrial development. And if you will observe carefully, you will find it borne out in your own organization. Coöperate

with your associates and enlist their coöperation and good will.

Do not be too quick to assume that there is no chance for advancement or change in your own company. Very often you will find that the opportunities there are just as great as in any other aggressive, growing company. It is just a matter of finding these.

When you adopt the principles of merchandizing for the purpose of selling your services, start with your very best prospect—your own company. Sometimes a change in your own organization takes longer to accomplish, but once you have found the right place you will have taken a firm step forward. This step forward will count to the advantage of yourself and your company.

Do not overlook your best prospect, your present employer.

Why Go with a Competitor?

Why Go with a Competitor?

GOING with a competitor is something you should consider carefully. After you have analyzed your qualifications, you may be inclined to believe that the best use can be made of these in a company in a competitive form of business. It is true that you can readily fit in with a new organization in a parallel line of business, so far as the nature of the product, the details of handling it, and the general nature of the organization are concerned.

However, you must remember that the best that your training and experience have put into you is a broader understanding of the principles that underlie the phase of industrial or business activity in which you have been engaged. There is a strong possibility, therefore, of your readily capitalizing the knowledge of

these principles in a somewhat different field that is not strictly competitive with that of your present employer.

In these days of highly organized effort the head of a large company looks out upon the members of his organization much in the same manner as a general over his captains, lieutenants, and soldiers. He feels that they are fighting with him. He counts on their unqualified loyalty. In military camps it is, of course, unpardonable for a man to go from his own camp to the camp of the enemy. He not only can never return to his own camp but history shows that he seldom remains in good grace with the enemy. This is a principle of strife that carries itself somewhat into business competition.

Therefore, when promotions to positions of responsibility are to be made, and the other considerations are at all equal, the executive is inclined, consciously or subconsciously, to give preference to the men whose loyalty has been absolutely proved.

Many employers in their advertisements for help specify "absolutely clean business record." The advertiser does not mean by this that he

expects that the applicant will show that he has never been in jail; that is taken for granted. He means something entirely beyond this. As a rule he is impressed by the cleanness of a man's record in that he has kept his relations with all his previous employers absolutely above reproach.

An older man may be justified from many viewpoints in changing to a competitor, but there is seldom any justification for this on the part of a young man. The young man must remember that he is starting out to build a business career. As he goes along, he must be careful not to take any false steps. Later on he too often finds that a change made in his previous years from one company to a competitor proves to have been a false step.

For instance, suppose that a man is making a serious effort to secure a big position with a new company. The prospective employer, of course, will look carefully into his record. If his record shows that he changed from one company to a competitor, such a change certainly will not stand out as an asset in his record—it even may have a negative value.

You can get a better endorsement and a more whole-hearted endorsement of yourself by your employer, when you go to a company in a somewhat different field. You will leave your present employer, with a kindly feeling on both sides, and you can always fall back on your record with him as a foundation in building your business career.

Consider the effect of your change upon the competitor whom you join. Perhaps at the start he has a good berth for you and a position into which you at the time advantageously fit. You commence at once to make yourself valuable to his company. However, no man is satisfied to think of just the position of the present. If he is intent upon establishing himself well, he will consider seriously how each change fits into his general advancement and progress.

Some time later your new employer—the competitor—has a good position open for somebody in his organization. He at least will be inclined to give the more responsible position to some man whose record for unqualified loyalty is absolutely proved. Disloyalty is often

attributed to the act of an employee in going from one employer to a competitor.

Later, you may want to go back to your old employer. In general, you stand an extremely poor chance to get back if you left him to go with a competitor. And even if you do succeed in getting back, your chances of rising very high in his organization are lessened. You lack the big asset, loyalty.

Of course, there are many men in classes of work that limit them, in selling their services, to seeking employment among competitors of their last employers. Necessity makes her own rules. It is impossible, therefore, to lay down a rule that it is bad practice to go with a competitor. However, such a course should be given more than mere passing consideration.

In general, try to capitalize the training in principles that you have received with your present employers, in some field that is not strictly competitive with his interests.

Make Good Use of Your Experience

Make Good Use of Your Experience

IF you find it advisable to eliminate the competitors of your present employer as possibilities, then consider the companies doing business allied to your present work. Such companies offer you a chance of getting into their service without handicapping yourself by entering an entirely new field.

The best course is to change to some company that is not a direct competitor of your present firm, but still close enough in the nature of its business to permit your making good use of the experience you already have acquired.

Besides the general nature of your prospective employer's business you must consider the kind of work you could do for him that would make you of the greatest value. This class of work, of course, will most often be in the direction of your previous experience. Unless you

are at present employed in work that is distasteful to you, and unless you feel sure that you could make a bigger success of some other kind of activity, you might better look for a class of work in which you have been trained. For instance, if you have been a salesman you might better make up your mind to get into the selling department of your prospective employer's business; if a superintendent, to get into the production department; a bookkeeper, into the accounting department.

Reach the Real Buying Factors

Reach the Real Buying Factors

ONCE you have made up your mind with regard to the class of companies you will approach, and the class of work for which you are best fitted in their organizations, pick out the particular individuals in these organizations who have the power of buying the class of service you have to offer for sale. It has been demonstrated in selling standard commodities to large organizations that it is important to get in touch with the real buying factors. You must recognize this principle in selling your services.

Do not let some representative of the company discourage your efforts to get with the company simply because he has not the capacity for making proper use of your services or the authority to hire you. Reach the right man and show him definitely how your particular

training and experience can be made useful to him in the development of his part of the organization.

"Help Wanted"

"Help Wanted"

THE "help wanted" columns provide the most immediate means for your learning who is in the market for the class of service you have to offer.

Do not be content to look over the want advertising columns of a single morning or evening newspaper in your city. Secure all of the newspapers every day. If you live in a big city, you have a fairly good choice of positions every day on which to start your sales campaign. If you live some distance from the nearest big city, subscribe at once for the principal papers issued in that city, or go to the local newsdealer for them.

Conduct your search systematically in order to get within your hands the largest possible number of prospects for your services. Build up your chances of picking just the right employer.

However, the newspapers should not be con-

sidered sufficient. Most public libraries have on file the leading technical or trade journals. The number of these will surprise you. There is scarcely a field of endeavor that has reached any considerable degree of development that has not its own technical journal. And you will be surprised at the number of positions offered in the classified columns of these technical or trade journals.

When you answer an advertisement in a technical paper, you will impress your prospective employer with the fact that you are a specialized man yourself—that you are one of his own field.

The fact that a position is advertised in a particular technical paper makes it possible for you to deduce from such an advertisement something of the nature of the business in which your prospective employer is interested. It is a principle in selling that it is exceedingly helpful to know something of your prospect's business interests. From the very beginning it gives you a better chance to show just how your product can be made useful to him.

"Situation Wanted"

"Situation Wanted"

YOU will find it difficult to get results in the regular "situations wanted" columns of the newspapers and technical journals unless you take up this phase of your campaign in some unusual way. The average advertiser is satisfied merely to make a statement of his qualifications in broad terms with little attempt at proof. This form of advertising is no longer recognized as effective in the marketing of other commodities, and there is no good reason to expect it to be sufficient in advertising for a job.

The limitation of funds may be the justification for the conventional so-many-line "situation wanted" advertisement in inconspicuous type, lost in the countless number of almost identical advertisements in style of phraseology and appearance. But if you recognize the principles of advertising in present-day merchandizing, then you can apply these principles

profitably to the form of advertising under discussion.

At best this form of advertising is handicapped by the natural inclination of executives to take the line of least resistance in obtaining employees. To offset this inclination and to create a favorable result, you will find it almost imperative to resort to some form of display advertising in the "situations wanted" columns.

As a start in running your "situation wanted" display advertising, select carefully the most promising mediums. Select the mediums that reach the greatest number of executives that hire men for the classes of work to which your training and experience naturally suit you or to which you most anxiously aspire.

The question of space will, of course, be governed largely by your pocketbook. But do not forget that a display advertisement, in more or less costly space, will be more economical if it raises an inquiry than the cheaper conventional form which is likely to run for several insertions with the common total lack of results.

If you are not satisfied that you can write a good advertisement covering your case, take

your "story" to some advertising man or to an advertising agency. Some "punch" put into the copy will probably make the small expenditure worth while.

For its suggestive value the appended "situation wanted" advertisement, which was placed in display form and accomplished the purpose, is offered:

An Open Letter of Application

Doesn't the summary of my fourteen years' experience, following a thorough schooling, with specialized courses in shop work and advertising, indicate a business building capacity?

1 year —railroad office work.
2 years—assistant to executive of huge corporation controlling mining properties.
2 years—selling a well-known mechanical product.
9 years—Present employer—a leading mechanical journal.
Duties: Editorial and office management.
Correspondence—extensive and intensive.
Advertising.

The intimate contact I have had with progressive sales work coupled with an exceptional office-executive experience leads me to this conclusion:

I can supply to some progressive manufacturing firm a commonly lacking, important factor—the factor that dovetails the office work with the selling forces.

An interview will consume only a few minutes of your time—if our interests are not mutual.

P W 696—American Machinist.

The Employment Agency

The Employment Agency

EMPLOYMENT agencies offer some possibilities. If you place your case with the right kind of employment agencies they may help you.

It certainly will pay you to get in touch with some of them. Wherever possible go to see them and analyze their representations. Do not deposit your fee with the first one you approach. Find out just which one has the best contact with the field in which you are interested.

In the technical fields, most of the societies operate an employment service for the use of which no charge is made. This service is not restricted to the membership.

However, the employment agencies are just one of many possible means of selling your services and are not entirely to be depended upon for decisive results.

The Circular Letter

The Circular Letter

CIRCULARIZING is a means of selling that has produced remarkable results in marketing many kinds of products. It offers excellent possibilities for selling your services.

For your mailing list take the names of companies that strike you favorably. Your own knowledge probably will enable you to compile a list of this kind. More extended lists can be secured readily from the many classified directories and the several forms of trade and technical literature.

The following is a circular letter of application written by an advertising man to a selected list of manufacturing companies. This letter secured some interviews. And he secured a position he liked.

1250 East 113 Street
Cleveland, Ohio
January 10, 1916

Mr. John T. Jewell, General Sales Manager
Coöperative Products Company
Akron, Ohio

Dear Sir:

I have an exceptional experience in advertising to offer you—a successful experience in advertising and selling just the kind of prospects appealed to by your company.

I mention *selling*, too, because I want you to know that my actual field work as a salesman has given me a sense of putting selling value into advertising copy.

The advertisements enclosed were done by me for the Bland Manufacturing Company, whom I am serving at present. They will give you a means of judging my work. I believe I could do mighty profitable work for you.

The interview you grant me will take only a few minutes of your time—unless our interests are mutual.

Yours respectfully,
(signed) C. A. Jones.

As in all classes of circularizing, your success will depend largely upon the form of your letter and what you put into it.

The Personal Call

The Personal Call

A FUNDAMENTAL in your campaign will be the making of personal calls on companies that offer possibilities and are located within a reasonable traveling distance from your headquarters.

The effectiveness of personal calls is dependent largely upon your ability to get to the right man in an organization to which you feel you could be useful. If you are unsuccessful in securing an interview with the right man, write him an appropriate letter requesting an interview.

In making personal calls, do not overlook the selling advantage of persistency. You may fail to interest any one of the first ten executives. But keep on trying.

A good salesman does not stop after he has seen ten prospects; he keeps on going. Perhaps the fifteenth man will like his product, and his

efforts will be repaid for the fourteen barren prospects he tried to interest.

The very nature of the personal call process demands patience and persistency.

The News Item

The News Item

AN almost altogether neglected possibility for turning up likely prospects is the news columns of both newspapers and trade journals. The changes that men are constantly making in the industrial world are made the subject of news items. And the vacancies thereby made known offer fertile ground to the ready applicant.

When the appointment to a responsible executive position is revealed in a news item, a letter to the new executive may get results. There is always a good possibility of reorganization on the part of the new executive. You may be able to impress him with the fact that you are alive to opportunities and that you do not wait for them to go begging. It certainly is a psychological time to show him how and why he needs you.

The announcements of new incorporations offer possibilities. New incorporations in start-

ing out quite naturally give a great deal of attention to the building up of their organizations. A receptive mood is therefore assured to voluntary applications.

The possibilities of marketing your services in this direction are quite promising. In this connection recourse to a press-clipping service may pay you.

What is Your Appeal?

What is Your Appeal?

IN order to be sure that you are taking advantage of good selling principles in marketing your services it is necessary that you approach your prospective employer with a definite appeal.

Begin this definite appeal in your letter of application. Then carry it straight through your interview and even through your follow-up on the interview.

The average letter of application starts with a few inane remarks, continues with a few sentences covering the applicant's education and experience, and ends up by crediting the author with a few general qualities like honesty, ambition, and enthusiasm. If you write this kind of letter in answer to an advertisement, you may be sure that most of the letters received by the prospective employer will be just like it.

Therefore, if you want to head your letter toward the waste-basket, write it in this form.

A better way is to analyze carefully the requirements stated by the employer and decide just how your own experience fits in with these requirements. Then lay your plans to demonstrate to the prospective employer that your previous training and experience have fitted you to be of service to him in the manner outlined in his advertisement.

Do not be satisfied with broad statements that you feel will make a sort of blanket appeal. Pick out some particular line of attack and follow this very definitely. When a merchant starts a sales campaign he picks out the strongest feature of his product on the basis of its value to the prospective user and he builds his advertising and sales campaign on direct appeals that feature this strongest quality.

Few employers these days hire a man because of his broad and liberal education or because he is well informed on a great variety of business subjects. They are looking for the man who fits in with their organization and who can do exceedingly well a particular kind of work.

This is a day of specialization and the employer is looking for a specialist. You may possess many commendable qualities beyond those immediately required, but it will be well to omit mention of them in your approach. Keep in mind the specialist viewpoint of the employer.

Make concentration the keynote of your appeal. It must be intensive on one point. If the requirements of the position are rather broad, you can show your qualifications for meeting these requirements in a general way.

But make a definite appeal.

Make Your Letter of Application Compel Attention

Make Your Letter of Application Compel Attention

SOMETIME during your business experience you have written letters of application that never brought replies. If your experience qualified you for the position, what does the failure to receive replies indicate? Simply that your letter—the only thing by which the prospective employer had to judge you—was lacking in some way.

When writing your letter of application bear firmly in mind that your prospective employer has no other means of appraising your services than by your letter. He is not a mind reader and can judge only from the actual contents of your letter.

In an analysis of a group of 167 applications for a position, the astounding fact was revealed

that while each of the applicants must have had a strong hope of securing an interview, over 63 per cent. of them were at once barred from consideration because their letters were lacking in essentials.

Most letters of application are written more or less spontaneously after a passing examination of the want advertisement. As a result most letters are neither comprehensive nor impressive. It is therefore an easy matter for an applicant to secure favorable attention if he really sets out to write a good letter of application.

You may be exceptionally capable in your field, but you will find yourself greatly handicapped in trying to better yourself if you do not write a good letter of application.

One of your chief merits in your previous experience may be that you have been a "sticker" —in other words, that you have been loyal to some company and made yourself expert and useful in some particular work with them. A change in the organization makes it necessary for you to look around for another position. You are at sea. The *job* of looking for a *job*

is new to you. You have had no experience in writing letters of application. And in applying for an advertised position you are likely to be in competition with letters written by applicants who have become rather expert in writing letters and landing jobs. The happy-go-lucky dispositions of these experts have inclined them to get tired very often of their work and therefore they have built up an experience in the art of securing new ones.

We are all familiar with the ability of the sleek salesman to unload an inferior article through the various devices that go to make up good salesmanship. The employer often has a similar condition to contend with in filling a position through correspondence.

You will have to contend with the selling methods used by your competitors for the position; in order to hold your own in marketing your services against this competition you must take advantage of effective selling principles in building up your letter.

You must remember then that no matter how perfectly you are suited for the position for which you are applying, unless you take ad-

vantage of selling principles in writing your letter, you stand little chance of receiving an answer.

This part of your campaign for a better position is most important and merits the most serious study.

Make Your Letter Eye-Sweet

Make Your Letter Eye-Sweet

AN employer advertises that a position is open. After the inflow of the letters of application has ceased, the employer takes the entire lot and starts to look over them. He tells himself, as he starts through them, that he must remember he is not looking for a good penman or an expert in the use of the English language—or even an expert letter writer. Therefore, he determines to be careful to judge the applicants not too much by the form of their letters but rather by their experience as represented.

Now this employer is a busy man and he is in the habit of getting through a pile of papers as rapidly as possible. He reads very patiently through perhaps the first ten badly arranged letters. Then he begins to pass them over a bit more rapidly. Finally, after about the twen-

tieth letter he shuffles the letters very rapidly. Unconsciously he has passed to judging the applicant by the typography of his letter.

If your letter is the fortieth, it will not even be read through unless it claims attention by its neat typographical arrangement and logical arrangement of the material presented.

If you do not present your experience in such form that it will at least be read through and receive some consideration, then what chance have you of getting an interview and finally landing the position? A very slim chance, as perhaps your own experience in writing letters of application has proved. Therefore, unless you know that your letter will create a favorable first impression, do not waste postage on it.

Your letter of application must create a good first impression. The first impression the letter creates depends upon its appearance. The appearance depends in part upon the kind of paper used and upon the typographical arrangement.

The best kind of paper to use is standard, business-size, letter-head sheets. Use plain paper of good quality.

Do not use the stationery of the firm you

are with at present. This may create a poor impression; some executives rather hold out against the employee who feels free to use the firm's supplies, such as stationery, stamps, and the like, and you may create the impression that you are one of this type of employee.

Do not use note paper of the kind that is used ordinarily in social correspondence. Every one has the right to his own opinion as to whether note paper has a place in business correspondence—ordinarily. But the point is, so far as your application is concerned, that there is a difference in opinion. The man to whom you are writing may be one of those that believe that note paper should be reserved for social correspondence. You cannot go wrong on this point if you use business-size stationery. Why take a chance? Use business-size.

Take the time to write out your letter in long hand, or make some kind of rough draft of it. Then go over it with the idea of perfecting the arrangement of the material you present. Break it up into paragraphs that are not too long. Have it typewritten. A well-arranged typewritten letter is bound to attract attention, even

though it may be the sixtieth to be reached.

Make your letter create a favorable first impression. Use good quality standard-size, business letter paper; perfect the arrangement of your letter; and have it neatly typewritten.

Make your letter "eye-sweet."

Prove That You Can Be of Service

Prove That You Can Be of Service

IT is accepted in advertising and selling that to arouse desire it is necessary to show how an article fills a definite need. It is accepted further in advertising and selling that the strongest appeals are those which are directed to self-interest. You must go about building up your letter, then, with the point of view of demonstrating that your prospective employer needs your services. You must show him that you can be of service to him. You must make him feel that it is to his interest to grant you an interview with the object of discussing in further detail just how your experience fits you for his service.

An effective way to open your letter is to make a simple statement that your training and experience make you the right man for the position in view. Then give your experience in

chronological order and in such a way that you emphasize the elements that bear on your being of service in the position advertised. Give a list of your references. End the letter by summarizing the reasons why the position will enable you and your prospective employer to capitalize to good advantage your training and experience.

The average executive is partial to conciseness. The letter will be neither too long nor too short, however, if you stick to the essentials of your experience that fit you for the position. It is not enough to state simply that your experience fits you for the position and then close by "hoping for an interview." Such letters, of which there is a lamentable volume, go into the waste basket. Reasons why your experience fits you for the position must be the foundation of your appeal.

In building up your letter try to make its substance and form reflect the type of man desired by the employer. If the position advertised is for a salesman it is essential that sales "punch" appear in the letter. If an advertising man is wanted, the letter should parallel the

form and substance of good advertising copy. If the job open is for an engineer, the analytical mind of the engineer should be reflected in a logical grouping of the details of experience. All classes of work are subject to some form of this treatment in the letter.

Put into your letter a spirit of openness. Tell your prospective employer the name of your present employer and tell him that you will be glad to give him later the names of your superiors in the organization, to whom he can refer finally. There is little need to fear violation of confidence in such matters, as there is not one executive among a thousand who has such a poor sense as to let your present employers know that you are seeking a change. In addition to the above-board spirit displayed in mentioning the name of your employer, it aids in supplying the one generally lacking quality in letters of application—*definiteness*. The name of the firm for which you are working enables an executive to form a more definite idea of the class of experience you have gained.

The last step in your letter must be an effort to stimulate your prospective employer to grant

you an interview. In making this appeal for an interview, keep your mind on the interview. Do not try to clinch the job with the letter.

Tell your prospective employer that you have set down the main factors of your experience that can be made profitable to him. Point out that your training and experience fit you so well for the position that you are satisfied that it is worth while for him to grant you the short time necessary for a personal interview.

Your letter will have served its whole function if you get to see your man.

The Salesman's Letter

The Salesman's Letter

The Advertisement

Salesman, 28 to 32 years old, for large mechanical manufacturing organization. Must have at least two years' successful selling experience. Adequate salary will be offered to right man. Address Box 332, *New York Times.*

The Answer

3008 Mt. Prospect Avenue
Newark, N. J.
December 20, 1916

Box 332
New York Times
New York City

Gentlemen:

My mechanical training and sales experience go to make up just the right combination for the position outlined. This training and experience are set forth in the following summary:

NOTE.—The letters given in the following chapters are for illustrative purposes and, of course, they do not cover many cases in detail. However, you may take the form and principles and build them into a letter to suit your particular requirements.

Training and Experience

1909 Graduated as mechanical engineer, Columbia University

1909-1911 Machine shop, Brown Machine Mfg. Co.

1911-1913 Drafting dept., Brown Machine Mfg. Co.

1913-1915 Assistant to chief engineer, Smith Pump Co.

1915-1916 Sales engineer, Smith Pump Co.

You will observe from the above record that I have had an excellent preparation to be of valuable service to you in the position you offer. My education and mechanical work after graduation have been of such a nature as to give me a good combination of the general theory of mechanical engineering together with definite manual practice.

The best proof I can offer you of my success as a salesman is that since my taking up this kind of work with my present firm two years ago they have advanced me rapidly in it. I shall be glad to show the evidence of this during a personal interview.

References

H. G. Brown, Brown Machine Mfg. Co.

A. R. Gray, Sales Manager, Brown Machine Mfg. Co.

T. B. Jones, General Manager, Globe Mfg. Co.
Smith Pump Company, with which I am at present employed (any of the sales department officials to whom I shall be glad to refer you later).

Other Details

I am 30 years old.
The Smith Pump Company is a mighty good organization and I like my position with it. Why I am making good as a salesman I can demonstrate to you in a few minutes' talk.

Yours very truly,
(signed) J. R. WOOLWORTH

P. S. If you are a competitor of my present employers, kindly return this application as I would not change to a competitor.

The Sales Correspondent's Letter

The Sales Correspondent's Letter

The Advertisement

Technical graduate, mechanical, with two years' practical experience. Work, sales correspondence with opportunity to become sales engineer with big and growing manufacturer. Address, E. F. Jones, Box 4200, Paterson, N. J.

The Answer

280 Bay Avenue
Montclair, N. J.
November 4, 1916

Mr. E. F. Jones
Box 4200
Patterson, N. J.

Dear Sir:

Confident that you will find me of value to you in the position you advertised in the *New York Herald*, I am presenting a brief, comprehensive outline of my experience.

I was educated in the grammar schools and Technical High School of Washington, D. C.,

and was graduated from the engineering course of the University of Pennsylvania in 1915. For a year and a half I was employed by the Pittsburgh Railways Company, where I handled the correspondence of two superintendents while preparing myself to be an assistant to one of them. My work with this company, though successful, was leading to a strictly technical position; therefore, I resigned to take a position as a correspondent with a large mail order firm in New York, where I handle all correspondence of an engineering or chemical nature. This position has given me valuable training in modern business methods, but does not enable me to use my engineering knowledge to the best advantage. I feel that I am better adapted by my education, experience, and natural inclination to fill the position open in your company.

I am enclosing the names of men who know me personally and to whom I refer you as to my character, ability, and education.

Please grant me an interview, a chance to convince you that I can successfully handle your sales correspondence.

Yours respectfully,

(signed) J. W. Briggs

A More General Letter

A More General Letter

The Advertisement

Executive assistant to take charge of office routine and system. Experience in mail order work an important asset. Must be thoroughly trained correspondent and possess executive ability. Some actual selling experience desirable. Give full particulars, state references and salary desired. Address Box Z 17, *Printers' Ink*, New York City.

The Answer

2008 Sherman Place
Brooklyn, N. Y.
January 2, 1916

Box Z 17
Printers' Ink
New York City

Gentlemen:

My training and experience fit me for precisely such a position as you outline.

For the past nine years I have been associated with the Blank Publishing Company in a ca-

pacity that has required the qualifications you emphasize.

The Blank Publishing Company is conceded to be a leader in the development of constructive office management methods. It is widely recognized as a pioneer in progressive mail-sales work. To what extent I have been instrumental in applying such progressive ideas to the sale of its publications can be best answered by its general manager, M. T. Brown. Much of the nine years' training and experience I have gained here should interest you.

Prior to my association with the publishing business I was assistant to the general manager of the extensive mining interests controlled by the Black Securities Company, New York City. Over a period of two years I acquired actual selling experience with the B. and D. Adding Machine Company.

The opportunity you outline attracts me. To have managed successfully a department of more than 20 office assistants makes me fully qualified to meet your most exacting requirements. I am confident that the endorsement of the following references in addition to those of my present employers will be enthusiastic:

F. A. Fogel, General Manager, Black Securities Co.

G. P. Griffin, President, Kings Realty Corp., Brooklyn, N. Y.
E. W. Manville, Vice President, General Sales Co., New York City.

In an interview I should appreciate the opportunity of discussing those details of my experience that I believe will convince you that I am the man you are seeking.
I am 32 years old and could make myself worth $3000 a year to you immediately.

Yours very truly,

(signed) W. G. Dunn

The Bookkeeper's Letter

The Bookkeeper's Letter

The Advertisement

Bookkeeper. Corporation desires young man not under 25, strictly temperate, to take full charge of books; he must have at least two years' experience, understand the modern efficient methods; also take dictation and operate Remington machine. This is an unusual opportunity for a man who can fill the position. Answer with full particulars, references, salary, and experience. A. D. Co., Box 672, *Chicago Tribune.*

The Answer

218 South 40 Street
Chicago, Ill.
December 15, 1916

A. D. Co. Box 672
Chicago Tribune
Chicago, Ill.
Gentlemen:
After my graduation from high school in 1908 I spent two years in completing a course in accounting and finance at the Springfield Business College.

In 1910 I took over the handling of the office work for the Springfield Coal Company. In addition to keeping the books, there was considerable stenography and typewriting that I had to look after, in which work I used the Remington machine.

The business has grown considerably during the past six years and I am therefore devoting all my time to the books. However, I do have to write letters for the general manager on special occasions and thereby manage to keep up my speed.

I am interested in your position because I believe it offers opportunity for the broadening of my experience and possibly applying that which I have already gained to better advantage. Most decidedly I feel prepared to meet your requirements and I feel confident that the many improvements I put into effect in the office work of my present employer will convince you that initiative and energy are part of my make-up. I am 26 years old.

If you have an investment of $30 a week to make in the position open, I feel certain that a short trial period will show you that I can make it pay you a good return.

Yours respectfully,

(signed) A. W. ANDERSON

A Letter that Accomplished the Unusual

A Letter that Accomplished the Unusual

The Advertisement

WANTED.—Technical Graduate, mechanical, with three or four years' experience, as assistant to general manager of growing manufacturing company. Salary, $150 a month to start. Address, Box 676, *Newark News.*

This letter did not get the job advertised—it got the applicant a better job, assistant advertising manager in the same organization.

The Answer

100 Oxford Street
Newark, N. J.
August 31, 1916

Box 676
Newark News
Newark, N. J.

Dear Sir:

I am twenty-eight years of age and was graduated from Columbia University as a mechanical engineer in 1913. At the concern where

I am at present employed I have been working as assistant to the general superintendent. I have gained a great deal of knowledge in all departments. In particular, I have had experience in correspondence.

A great deal of experience has been acquired in

1. Designing
2. Pattern Shop
3. Foundry
4. Machine Shop
5. Office
6. Selling

I am getting more salary here than you offer. However, I am willing to make a change if the opportunity is good for a reliable and progressive young man.

Kindly fates warn men of impending disaster. I have been working for this concern since graduation. Lately, I discovered if advancement is desirable, a change must be made. All the executive positions are held by men who are related. I see no future here.

My experience and your requirements appear to square. In an interview, for which I shall be glad to appear at any time, you could no doubt draw more accurate conclusions.

Yours very truly,

(signed) W. R. Boland

The Engineer's Letter

The Engineer's Letter

The Advertisement

WANTED.—Electrical engineer to take charge of electrical apparatus, power plant, and lighting system for a large department store. State experience, age, and salary desired. Address Box 452, *Electrical World*, New York City.

The Answer

822 Taylor Street
Easton, Pa.
October 3, 1916

Box 452
Electrical World
New York City

Gentlemen:

The analysis of my experience as given below will enable you to judge whether I am technically and practically the man for the position you have to fill:

1902-1906 Electrical engineering course, University of Pennsylvania
1906-1908 Apprenticeship course, Westinghouse Electric and Mfg. Co., E. Pittsburgh, Pa.
1908-1910 Engineering department, Westinghouse Electric and Mfg. Co.
1910-1916 Lafayette Street Railways Co., substation work

You will observe that my experience has given me a thorough training to handle competently the installation and operation of power plant equipment. During my experience with the Lafayette Street Railways Company I came in direct touch with many lighting problems and I therefore feel well qualified to take charge of that part of the work in a way that will secure maximum efficiency at low cost.

I am 33 years old and at an initial salary of $150 a month, I could yield you an immediate profit.

Yours very truly,
(signed) JOHN W. RUHL

P. S. Please see my article in . . . issue of *Electrical World* on "Cost Reducing Methods in the Small Power Plant."

The Foreman's Letter

The Foreman's Letter

The Advertisement

High-grade toolmaker to take charge of large toolroom specializing in punch and die work. Must be thoroughly accomplished and possess executive ability. Give details, experience and salary desired. P. W. 116, *American Machinist*, New York.

The Answer

P. O. Box 876
Bridgeport, Conn.
November 11, 1916

P. W. 116
American Machinist
New York City

Gentlemen:

As toolroom foreman for the Blank Machine and Tool Company I saved $4700 during the past year, while the pay of the 40 hands was increased an average of eight per cent. The work was largely of the punch and die variety, for the design of which I was personally responsible.

The record given below is my answer as to how I was able to accomplish such a result:

Four years, James and Laughlin Mfg. Co., machinist

Five years, Hopkins Instrument Company, toolmaker; advanced to assistant foreman after the second year

Four years, Madison Machine, Tool and Die Co., assistant toolroom foreman, and for a short time before going with my present employers, foreman.

The three years I have been with my present firm round out a toolroom experience, largely devoted to punch and die practice, that makes me confident I can fill the position you offer.

A bigger opportunity in which I could demonstrate my worth at $2500 a year from the start would attract me. I am at present earning $2000.

Age, 38 years.

References: Any past employer.

In an interview I could furnish further details that I feel sure are bound to interest you.

Yours truly,

(signed) W. H. Boyd

Do Not

Do Not

DO not start your letter with the statement that you read the advertisement and that it interests you. You merely waste your words. The employer knows you read the advertisement and that it interests you. Otherwise you would not have replied.

Do not burden your letter with such statements as: "I realize that a large number of applications will doubtless be received and that it will require a great deal of your time to read them all, and it will probably be very difficult to decide," etc.

Do not make any statements like the following: "There is scarcely anything in the nature of bookkeeping and accounting problems of today of which I am not a master."

Do not use "long hand" if you can avoid it or unless it is specified in the advertisement. Typewriting is inexpensive.

Do not send a letter done in *careless* handwriting.

Do not use social note paper.

Do not write on both sides of the sheet.

Do not write with a lead pencil.

Do not forget, if you are a poor speller, that it is easy to check yourself by reference to a dictionary. A misspelled word in a letter of application sticks out like a sore thumb.

Do not be general in outlining your experience record. Give the names of the companies and the length of service with them.

Do not fail to comply with every individual item of the advertisement. Strict compliance with the details suggests the observant.

Do not rely on general statements. Employers like to draw their own conclusions from definite concrete facts.

Do not volunteer any statements to the effect that you are not interested in salary if the prospects are bright. Executives are not looking for "something for nothing" offers.

Do not put the salary question on the basis of what you must have, but rather in the form of what you can make yourself worth.

Do not make inquiries that will indicate more interest in personal advantages than in serving your prospective employer.

Do not make any flippant, bombastic, or studied clever remarks.

Do not be egotistical. There's a difference between egotism and confidence.

Do not try to describe your general personal characteristics, enthusiasm, loyalty, appearance, etc. These are qualities for which no one will take your own word.

Do not talk about your family.

Do not specify details of your personal habits, such as smoking, chewing, and drinking. The average employer has at least one of these habits. Take no chance of stepping on his toes.

Do not fail to state your age—unless your withholding it fulfills some definite purpose.

Do not fail to give references.

Do not enclose original letters of recommendation or other papers of value to blind addresses. Send copies.

Why Neglect the Follow-Up Letter?

Why Neglect the Follow-Up Letter?

WHEN a sales organization picks out a group of prospects toward which to direct a campaign for business by sales letters, the organization usually makes it a part of the campaign to direct several letters to each prospect. The letters are so constructed that a single point is taken up in each letter for concentrated selling. If there are several points to be considered in demonstrating the article to be sold and convincing the prospect to the point of buying, it takes several letters to cover these points. The average campaign then actually consists of the first letter, which may be compared to your letter of application, and several follow-up letters.

It is a rather astonishing fact that the principle of the follow-up, so well demonstrated in ordinary business sales letter work, is almost

never used by an applicant for a position.

The statements of several executives reveal the fact that during many years of experience in receiving several thousand letters of application, no one of them ever received a single follow-up letter.

There is a superlative reason why the follow-up on your letter of application should be even more effective than the average follow-up letter selling a piece of merchandise. Besides the chances that you have in your follow-up letters of selling your services to your prospective employer for some other work than that outlined in your letter of application, there is the possibility of impressing him with your qualities of persistency and "wide-awakefulness"—qualities that are looked upon with favor by all classes of employers.

Although you omit from your letter of application all claims to personal qualities, such as enthusiasm, aggressiveness, tact, and resourcefulness, you can appropriately discuss in your follow-up letter what personal characteristics you think are important in the man who will most suitably fill the position advertised.

Point to your experience record presented in your letter of application as an indication that you have the personal characteristics necessary. Finally you can point out to your prospective employer that these qualities are such that they can be judged only by a personal interview.

You can depend upon it that you will have plenty of competition against your letter of application, but you will have very little competition against your follow-up letters. Therefore, if you use follow-up letters you at least will impart some distinctiveness to your application.

It is almost certain that your follow-up letter will guarantee a second reading of your letter of application. If your letter of application is a good one and you are pretty well suited for the work—as well suited as several other applicants—the second reading will greatly enhance your chance of getting the position. It will almost certainly insure your getting an interview.

For certain classes of employment, such as selling and collecting, your very persistence may appeal so strongly to your prospective

employer as actually to land you the job.

The follow-up gives you a fine opportunity to emphasize some phase of your experience, as presented in your letter of application, in such a way as further to impress favorably the employer.

As a means of suggestion and guidance, there are set forth in the following chapter several follow-up letters on the letters of application presented in the previous chapters. However, you will have to work out a follow-up that will best suit your particular requirements and assure an individual consideration of your case.

If the follow-up letter makes good in sales letters, collection letters, and the almost endless variety of other classes of business stimulating correspondence, why not take advantage of it in your campaign for a job?

Effective Follow-Up Letters

Effective Follow-Up Letters

Follow-up letter on the salesman's letter of application (see page 97).

3008 Mt. Prospect Avenue
Newark, N. J.
December 26, 1916

Box 332
New York Times
New York City.

Gentlemen:

On December 20 I wrote you in regard to the position you advertised.

To be successful in sales work, a man must be enthusiastic, diplomatic, and aggressive; and he must have a power of personal impression. Whether a man has these qualities you can judge only by seeing him and talking with him. When you look over my complete record as pre-

viously presented to you, I know that you will judge that I am worthy of an interview.

Yours truly,

(signed) J. R. WOOLWORTH

Follow-up letter on the sales correspondent's letter (see page 103).

280 Bay Avenue
Montclair, N. J.
November 8, 1916

Mr. E. F. Jones
Box 4200
Paterson, N. J.

Dear Sir:

In my letter to you of November 4 I enclosed the names of those who know me personally and know of my work.

I feel so well qualified for the position advertised and I am so interested in the possibilities of rendering you profitable service in it, that I have made it a point to get in touch with the gentlemen to whom I referred you. I find that you have not as yet made inquiry of them.

I realize that few employers actually consult references. However, I feel that mine are of such a character that you will be repaid for the time to find out from them whether I have the

right personal characteristics you consider necessary for the position open.

Or perhaps you feel that you would be better able to judge of these in an interview. This would also appeal to me as a better way and I trust you will give me permission to call upon you. I certainly shall be glad to meet an appointment at any time that you will specify.

Yours very truly,

(signed) J. W. Briggs

The follow-up letter that was used on the more general letter of application given on page 107 approached the prospective employer from a little different angle. It is offered as a suggestion of excellent possibilities. It will be observed that it was written, at the suggestion of the applicant, by one of his references.

New York, N. Y.
January 4, 1916

Box Z 17
Printers' Ink
New York City

Dear Sir:

Mr. W. G. Dunn has told me that he has applied to you for a position as executive assistant

and office manager and that he used my name as a reference.

Instead of waiting for you to inquire about Mr. Dunn, I am taking a few minutes to tell you that after reading your advertisement I feel that Mr. Dunn's training and experience make him just the man for the position you have open. I knew Mr. Dunn as a business associate when I was a member of the organization for which he now works. I often talked with him about the possibilities of his changing to sales work or some work with more of a business punch to it. I encouraged him in this direction because I realize that he has the right kind of personality for sales success.

I am not going to make a detailed reference to Mr. Dunn's ability as an office manager. His nine years with his present company, one of the largest in its field, speaks for itself.

If there is any further information that I can give you with regard to Mr. Dunn, do not hesitate to write or telephone me. I should like to be of service to you both.

Yours truly,

General Sales Co.,

(signed) E. W. MANVILLE

Vice President

In using this form of follow-up the applicant has taken advantage of the principle that what one man says about himself carries little weight as compared with what another man, accepted because of his training, position or standing as being competent to judge, says about him.

A man seeking a position uses the names of references who, if consulted by the prospective employer, will increase his possibilities of securing the position. The foregoing follow-up letter does not wait for the employer's action. Good selling! Good salesmen do not wait for their prospects to take action. They try to induce action.

A follow-up letter on the letter of application that did not get the position advertised, but got a better position with the same organization. See letter of application on page 117.

Newark, N. J.
September 5, 1916

Box 676 *Newark News*
Newark, N. J.

Dear Sir:

In my letter to you of August 31 I pointed out that I desired to make a change from my present

company because the executive positions are held by men who are related and because I see no future here.

Since writing you it has occurred to me that I might have created the impression that I am the type of fellow who becomes disgruntled rather easily, and I might even have created the impression that I am of the "unappreciated genius" type.

I am so thoroughly interested in the position you outlined that I am anxious to forestall any such impressions. Accordingly I am enclosing a copy of a letter I received from the president of the company a short time ago after I had been successful in completing a big negotiation. I believe this letter will convince you that I am successful in my present work. I believe further that I can make a greater success of the work you have to offer. A short interview will give me plenty of time to prove this. I have some other "exhibits" I should appreciate your examining.

Yours very truly,

(signed) W. R. Boland

The follow-up forms given represent only a few of the forms available. The form you use must be governed by your individual conditions,

the advertisement, and the type of the advertiser. The few forms given are of a general character and can be applied in a great many cases. But the main point in presenting them is to stimulate your thought on the virtues of the follow-up letter and to emphasize its possible utility to you.

Hustle While You Wait

Hustle While You Wait

DO not be satisfied with follow-up letters on your letter of application. Consider the merits of the telegram.

The telegram is an attention-compeller. You may be sure that you will at least get some credit for alertness if you follow up with a telegram. Just what form the telegram should take will depend upon the circumstances surrounding your application.

You may not be able to do much direct selling right in your telegram, but you will find it a valuable aid in carrying the impression that you are resourceful and alert.

As an illustration of what can be done by a little alertness the telegram below is given for its suggestive value. This applicant for a position of large opportunity, for which there was keen competition, departed considerably from the conventional attitude of watchful waiting.

The position advertised was open in a plant some 400 miles from the home of the successful applicant. He wrote his letter and then followed it up with this telegram:

Unless you wire me on receipt of this night telegram that the position for which I applied is already filled I will leave for your plant to-morrow night in order to see you personally My training and experience are such that you cannot fail to realize my fitness for the job when I furnish details and I am fully willing to risk the traveling expenses involved in case of a turn-down

The receptive mood that awaited this applicant can be readily imagined. He secured the job.

In a certain case the following night-letter-gram got results:

In my letter to you of January third I referred to R G Jones president Jones Manufacturing Company I just learned that Mr Jones leaves for an extended trip on Tuesday Will you not please get in touch with him before he leaves I believe he will be able to tell you something interesting about my experience in its relation to the work you outline

Make a Prompt and Good Appearance for the Interview

Make a Prompt and Good Appearance for the Interview

WHEN you are fortunate enough to get a letter from a company in answer to your application, requesting you to call at a certain time, by all means get there at the appointed time. It really is astonishing how indifferent some men are to opportunity knocking at the door. Employers tell of men who have been asked to call with regard to a position and who have replied by asking for a postponement because of some outing on the date specified or because of some other such foolish excuse.

Do not take the time to present a poor excuse for not appearing at the time requested. You might just as well save yourself the trouble. You will not get the job.

Good salesmen have proved that good sam-

ples are a great help in selling. They have also demonstrated that even where the physical appearance of an article has absolutely no relation to its inherent merit it is a good plan to make the sample look as attractive as possible.

Therefore, look to your personal appearance. Your appearance is important because your prospective employer must judge you quickly. He is bound to be influenced to a certain extent by externals. You may be very brainy, but it will take you more time to prove it against a bad impression caused by a poor personal appearance. It takes more time than you will have in an interview.

Give some thought then to your personal appearance. It should be conservative.

Reflect seriously on the merits of a hearty handshake. Employers register consciously the reaction produced by a man's handshake. They place great faith in this as an index of a man's personality. Probably you will not be able to accomplish the vise-like clasp of a blacksmith. But put your heart and strength into your grip.

Meet Your Prospective Employer's Point of View

Meet Your Prospective Employer's Point of View

THE most charming conversationalists are the good listeners. A salesman finds it of tremendous value in interviewing a prospect to be able to be responsive to his prospect's point of view. Knowing his prospect's business enables the salesman to be a good listener.

When a salesman takes up a big deal, he makes it a point not only to know the product he is trying to sell and its suitability for the service in view, but to know as much as possible about his prospect's business. He makes it a point to get as quickly as possible a sense of his prospect's point of view.

In selling your services try to keep well in mind a sense of your prospective employer's

point of view on the type of man he wants for the job in hand.

Not one applicant in a thousand ever thinks of making a study of his prospective employer's business. Be the exception. Before you appear for your interview, make some inquiries regarding the affairs of the company. Find out about their financial standing and their position in their field. Go to the public library and make a study of the products they make or handle.

The employer is interested in your reasons for desiring to be associated with his company. If you know something of his company and the kind of work it does, you will be able to show how you can be of service. Do not give any personal reasons, such as a desire to move your family's residence. Do not tell him that the people you are at present employed by are not of the right kind. Such a statement is too hard to prove.

In general, then, take it for granted that the prospective employer is not at all interested in your personal affairs or personal reasons for wanting to get the job. He is trying to secure a man who will be of the best value to him.

Confine yourself to demonstrating that you want the position because you feel that in such a position you can best capitalize your previous training and experience, both to him and to yourself.

As a means of focusing attention on the position and of giving you something definite to talk about, lay out on a sheet of paper in a logical form the characteristics of the ideal man for the position in hand. You can then take up these characteristics one at a time and show your prospective employer just how your training and experience have developed in you the various characteristics set forth.

It is a good plan to have with you any samples of work you have done, or any letters that bear on your having made good in your previous positions.

If your prospective employer asks you how long it will be before you can take up his work, do not fail to provide for plenty of notice to your present employer. Honesty is certainly the best policy. If you show your prospective employer that you are not inclined to be very fair to your present employer, he may become

suspicious that you might treat him the same way. Such a lack of consideration will not help you to land the job.

In contemplating your interview cast about for some means of talking about the position in view or about how various phases of your experience fit you for the position. During the interview try to direct your conversation in such a way as to avoid the necessity of too many direct statements about yourself. One of the hardest things in the world to do gracefully is to talk about oneself. This is usually a tiring subject to any listener.

The main thing for you to keep in mind during your interview is to limit your remarks to the features of your work and experience that promise a capacity for valuable service to your prospective employer.

Do not ramble off into irrelevant remarks about your brilliant accomplishments. Talk more about the position than about yourself.

The Eternal Question – the Salary

The Eternal Question —the Salary

WHEN the salary question comes along be prepared with some definite ideas of your own. It is doubtful if leaving the salary question entirely with the employer to decide makes a good impression on him. Have some idea of your possible earning capacity in the position advertised. If you are asked what salary you want, specify that amount.

The position advertised has an approximate value to the employer. He capitalizes the work done in that position at a certain amount. You may have been earning more or less. If you can approximate what such a position is worth, name that figure.

The average employer has no intention of bartering with you about the salary. If the position is worth a certain salary, he would

rather pay this to exactly the right man for the place, than to get a man for less who looked less promising.

You have little chance of getting any considerable amount more for the job than it pays normally. The economics of the employer's organization will prevent him from paying you more for the position than the amount at which he can capitalize this particular position in the work of his organization. He may be quite ready to believe that you have been making more than the salary he places on the position and that you are quite capable of earning more than this figure—but not at the position he has to fill.

During the Interview—Do Not

During the Interview —Do Not

DO not wear "loud" clothes.

Do not walk into a private office with your hat on.

Do not walk into an office with a cigar, cigarette, or pipe in your mouth or hand.

Do not lay a limp hand in your prospective employer's hand—grip his hand firmly.

Do not fall back into a chair as though you were going to sleep in it. Sit upright. When you stand, stand upright.

Do not put your hat on the executive's desk.

Do not try to force intimacy with the executive.

Do not try to hand him a cigar.

Do not try to do all the talking—be a responsive listener.

Do not bring up purely personal matters.

Do not be egotistical—speak with confidence of your work.

Do not "knock" your present or past employers. Speak well of them.

Do not try to give the impression that you are a martyr in your present position.

Do not let the interview grow stale. When you feel that you have gone as far as you can toward closing the deal, get out.

Keep Your Case Alive

Keep Your Case Alive

IF you have the feeling that all went well during the interview, and that the job is all but landed, do not trust so dangerous an idea. Perhaps the executive simply hated to hurt your feelings too brutally and tried to let you down easy until he could interview other competitors. Do not ever be sure that you have landed the job until the word has been finally given to you. Salesmen know that an order is never really sold until the goods are shipped and the bill is paid.

If you feel dissatisfied with the impression you think you made during the interview or feel that you have been eliminated from the competition, readjust yourself. The employer may have been either naturally or deliberately undemonstrative. If he had other men to interview, he certainly would try not to give you the impression that he had decided you were the right man for the job.

Keep on with your selling methods. A good salesman never gives up until he has some positive proof that his competitor has taken the business. The very interest you display in the position in following it aggressively may be one of your best appeals to the executive.

When a salesman calls on a prospect and fails to close a sale, he immediately begins after the interview to plan what he can do to further his project. Do some planning yourself after your interview with your prospective employer.

There are four general forms of follow-up on the interview: a letter, telegram, telephone call, or another call in person.

In sales departments that are run at all efficiently a follow-up letter is sent to a prospect after the salesman's call. This letter usually reiterates the selling points advanced by the salesman and emphasizes the points that are most important according to the salesman's report of the interview.

You at least ought to write a follow-up letter at once. Base this letter on some of the points brought out in your discussion with the executive. Your interview should have pro-

vided you with a better sense of his point of view and of what he is looking for in the man who will get the position. This will provide you with some ideas for your follow-up letter.

As one means of following up the executive after your interview you may have your references write him. Their letters should set forth their convictions of your suitability for the position open in such a way as to meet the viewpoint of the executive as brought out during your interview.

If you do not hear from your prospective employer within a few days from your interview do not be afraid to get in touch with him again, either by telephone or by another call at his office. No man ever resents the right kind of persistence. The chances of securing any position are always enhanced by a display of "wide-awakefulness." Work out some kind of follow-up by letter, telegram, telephone, or another call in person. In order to make this follow-up most effective, tie it up in some way with something brought out during the interview. No matter how comfortable or uncomfortable you

feel about the impression you made during the interview, keep active in following up your attack.

Keep your case alive!